

Abhijeet Palanki

Lead Frontend Developer

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SUMMARY

Lead Frontend Developer with nearly 10 years of building high-traffic web and mobile applications in React, Next.js, React Native and TypeScript. Currently co-leading a 17-developer team on Tropical Smoothie Cafe's online ordering platform. Strongest in component and micro-frontend architecture, rendering performance, test automation, and tracing production issues to their root cause before changing code.

SKILLS

Frontend: React.js (Hooks, Suspense, concurrent features), Next.js (SSR, ISR), React Native (iOS/Android, Hermes), TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Redux Toolkit, RTK Query, Tailwind CSS, SCSS, HTML5, CSS3

Architecture: Micro-frontends (Module Federation), shared cross-platform core libraries, component systems and design tokens, event-driven systems

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library, Playwright, Cypress, Detox, Mocha, Storybook + Chromatic

Observability and data: Datadog RUM, AWS CloudWatch, Quantum Metric, OpenTelemetry, Braze, mParticle, Mixpanel

DevOps: Git, GitHub Actions, Bitbucket Pipelines, GitLab CI, Docker, Kubernetes, Webpack, Vite

AI: OpenAI APIs, embeddings, Pinecone vector search, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Model Context Protocol (Jira, Confluence)

EXPERIENCE

Lead Frontend Developer · Tropical Smoothie Cafe (Contract)

Atlanta, GA · Feb 2026 – Present

- Co-lead frontend development for the new tropicalsmoothiecafe.com ordering platform with a second lead, guiding 17 developers (5 onshore, 12 offshore) across a Next.js app, a React component library and a shared TypeScript core also used by the React Native app.
- Built and launched ordering features across menu customization, cart, checkout, rewards, reorder, favorites, delivery and group ordering, delivering 100+ features and fixes.
- Review pull requests daily across three repositories, holding changed code to full test coverage and every bug fix to before/after evidence; run releases across dev, stage and production, including cherry-picks, reverts and verification of deployed builds.
- Triage production issues with Datadog RUM, AWS CloudWatch, Quantum Metric session replays and Cloudflare, and diagnosed customer identity and analytics defects across Braze, mParticle and Mixpanel.
- Mapped the three codebases into 16 traced features and proposed an incremental refactoring plan in place of a full rewrite; built an internal explorer, generated from source, that maps 20 customer journeys to their API calls and analytics events.
- Run pair-programming sessions and workshops for offshore developers on Next.js server-side rendering, React Native performance and AI-assisted coding with Claude Code and GitHub Copilot.

UI (React/React Native) Developer · Sam's Club / Walmart (Contract)

Bentonville, AR · Jul 2024 – Jan 2026

- Architected cross-platform React Native modules with native iOS/Android bridges on the Hermes engine, improving startup time and runtime performance for high-traffic mobile workflows.
- Architected micro-frontend modules with Module Federation, enabling independent deployments across enterprise web applications.
- Built a Gen-AI item catalog maintenance tool using OpenAI embeddings and Pinecone vector search, with low-latency inference instrumented through OpenTelemetry.
- Built an AI personalization engine that tailors the UI through embedding-powered recommendations and vector similarity search.
- Designed a Redux Toolkit + RTK Query data layer with normalized caching, request deduplication and background revalidation.
- Improved rendering performance for 1M+ daily active users with Suspense, concurrent features, virtualization and memoization.
- Automated E2E testing with Playwright, Cypress and Detox, cutting regression run time by 40% through parallelization, and kept code coverage at 85%+.
- Built a Storybook + Chromatic component system with automated visual regression testing; implemented edge caching and CDN-level API optimizations; managed CI/CD for Node.js microservices on Docker, Kubernetes and GitLab.

React JS Developer · Tyler Technologies (Full-time)

Remote · Dec 2020 – Apr 2024

- Engineered enterprise React applications on a micro-frontend architecture with dynamic Module Federation and runtime dependency injection.
- Improved performance and SEO of public-facing portals with Next.js SSR and ISR, a 25% improvement in First Contentful Paint.

- Built drag-and-drop workflow engines with React-Draggable and custom concurrency-optimized hooks.
- Designed API middleware with Axios interceptors, token refresh, exponential backoff and centralized error handling.
- Reduced bundle size through tree-shaking, code splitting, lazy loading and dynamic imports.
- Built test pipelines with Jest, Mocha and React Testing Library with enforced coverage thresholds, and containerized frontends on Docker and Kubernetes, cutting deployment time by 30%.
- Led code reviews and mentored junior engineers on testing, architecture and accessibility.

Arkansas Department of Education (Contract)

Little Rock, AR · Aug 2018 – Dec 2020

React JS Developer

Jul 2020 – Dec 2020

- Built multi-screen React SPAs with reusable TypeScript component libraries, and custom hooks for debounced REST calls and WebSocket streams with resilient reconnection.
- Delivered responsive, WCAG-aligned UI, and automated unit and integration tests with Jest and Enzyme, reducing manual QA cycles by 25%.

Frontend Developer

Aug 2018 – Jul 2020

- Implemented Single Sign-On for the MySped and MyAdmin applications with the ADE R&T team.
- Built React applications that render on both client and server from one codebase, on an atomic design system of reusable components.
- Added PWA capabilities (service workers, offline caching, push notifications) and custom Redux middleware for event tracing and performance monitoring; cut Time to Interactive by 30% through Lighthouse and React Profiler audits.

Programmer Analyst · Walmart (Contract)

Bentonville, AR · Jan 2017 – Jun 2018

- Built Angular 4 and TypeScript applications with RxJS state patterns and Angular Material, including user login authentication.
- Reduced bundle size with AOT compilation, tree-shaking and lazy loading, and enforced coverage gates with Jasmine and Karma in CI.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- **2048, animated with zero animation libraries** (React, Sass): two nested Sass loops generate all 24 tile-move keyframes at build time, so React only picks a class name; 44 KB of JavaScript, gzipped.
- **Shirty**, a 3D shirt customizer (React Three Fiber, Three.js, valtio, Framer Motion): color, logo and full-print options on a lit 3D model.
- **LiveDocs**, a collaborative document editor (Next.js, Lexical, Liveblocks, Clerk, Sentry), and **Whiz**, a video conferencing app (Next.js, Stream Video SDK, Clerk).

EDUCATION

M.S., Computer Science · University of Bridgeport, CT

2015 – 2016

B.Tech., Electronics & Communication · SRM University, Chennai, India

2011 – 2015